4. UI/UX Design Brief

Project: Advanced Personal Portfolio Website + Admin Panel **Direction:** Dark Premium + Futuristic Interactive (cinematic, restrained) **Version:** 1.0

> **Roman Urdu summary:** Yeh document website ki shakal, rang, fonts, spacing, animation timing aur har section ka layout define karta hai. AI builder isay follow karega to poori website ek hi consistent style mein banay gi, aur admin panel bhi usi design system ka hissa hoga.

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1. Design Principles

1. **Premium but calm** — dark charcoal canvas, generous space, one accent colour used with discipline.
2. **Content first** — effects support the work; they never delay reading it.
3. **Cinematic moments, not constant motion** — big motion only in the intro/reveal; everything else is quiet and short.
4. **Consistent system** — one set of tokens for colour, type, spacing, radius, shadow, motion across public site and admin.
5. **Inclusive by default** — contrast, focus, reduced motion, touch targets are design requirements, not polish.
6. **Honest UI** — no fake stats, no inert buttons, no hover-only information.

2. Design Tokens

2.1 Colour (CSS variables)

Token	Dark theme	Light theme	Usage
`--bg`	`#0A0B10`	`#F7F8FB`	Page background
`--surface`	`#11131A`	`#FFFFFF`	Cards, panels
`--surface-2`	`#181B25`	`#EEF0F6`	Raised/hover surfaces, inputs

Token	Dark theme	Light theme	Usage
`--border`	`#262B38`	`#D9DDE8`	Hairlines, card borders
`--text`	`#F5F6FA`	`#0F1220`	Primary text
`--text-muted`	`#A3A9BA`	`#4B5265`	Secondary text
`--accent`	`#7C5CFF`	`#5B3FE0`	Buttons, key highlights (fills)
`--accent-text`	`#A794FF`	`#4A2FCB`	Accent coloured text/links
`--accent-2`	`#22D3EE`	`#0891B2`	Limited secondary highlight (max one per section)
`--success`	`#34D399`	`#047857`	Success states
`--warning`	`#FBBF24`	`#B45309`	Warnings, SAMPLE badge
`--danger`	`#F87171`	`#B91C1C`	Errors, destructive
`--focus`	`#C4B5FD`	`#5B3FE0`	Focus ring

Gradients: `--grad-accent: linear-gradient(135deg,#7C5CFF 0%,#22D3EE 120%)` (used only on hero highlight, primary CTA hover glow and thin dividers). Hero glow: radial gradient of `--accent` at 18 % opacity. **No neon on every component.** All text pairs must reach **4.5:1** (3:1 for large text and UI borders) — verify with a contrast checker, especially `--accent` buttons with white text and `--text-muted` on `--surface-2`.

The owner may switch the accent to electric blue (`#3B82F6` , text `#93C5FD`) from admin settings; only approved palettes that pass contrast are offered.

2.2 Typography

Role	Font suggestion	Size (mobile → desktop)	Weight / line-height
Display (hero H1)	**Space Grotesk** or **Sora**	`clamp(2.5rem, 7vw, 5.5rem)`	700 / 1.05, letter-spacing −0.02em
H2 section titles	same family	`clamp(1.875rem, 4vw, 3rem)`	600 / 1.15

Role	Font suggestion	Size (mobile → desktop)	Weight / line-height
H3 / card titles	same family	1.25–1.5 rem	600 / 1.3
Body	**Inter**	1rem (16 px) → 1.0625rem	400 / 1.65
Small / meta / labels	Inter	0.8125–0.875 rem	500 / 1.4, uppercase labels with +0.08em tracking only for eyebrows
Urdu (if enabled)	**Noto Nastaliq Urdu** or **Noto Naskh Arabic**	+10 % size	line-height 2.0
Code/mono (admin, tags)	**JetBrains Mono**	0.875 rem	400

Max two Google families loaded, self-hosted subsets, `font-display: swap`, fallback stack tuned to avoid layout shift. Body line length 60–75 characters.

2.3 Spacing, radius, elevation

- **Spacing scale (px):** 4, 8, 12, 16, 24, 32, 48, 64, 96, 128. Section vertical padding: 64 (mobile), 96 (tablet), 128 (desktop).
- **Container:** max-width 1200 px (content 720 px for prose); side padding 20 px mobile, 32 px tablet, 48 px desktop.
- **Radius:** `--r-sm 8px`, `--r-md 14px`, `--r-lg 22px`, `--r-pill 999px`.
- **Shadows (dark):** `0 1px 0 rgba(255,255,255,.04) inset, 0 12px 32px rgba(0,0,0,.45)`; hover adds accent glow `0 0 0 1px rgba(124,92,255,.35), 0 16px 40px rgba(124,92,255,.15)`.
- **Glass (navbar/drawer):** `background: rgba(17,19,26,.65); backdrop-filter: blur(14px) saturate(140%); border: 1px solid var(--border)`; solid fallback when `backdrop-filter` unsupported.

2.4 Motion tokens

Token	Value
`--dur-fast`	180 ms (hover, press)
`--dur-base`	350 ms (reveals, menus)
`--dur-slow`	700 ms (section/hero reveals)
`--dur-cinema`	1200–1400 ms (intro → hero transition only)
`--ease-out`	`cubic-bezier(0.22, 1, 0.36, 1)`
`--ease-in-out`	`cubic-bezier(0.65, 0, 0.35, 1)`
Reveal distance	24 px upward + fade
Stagger step	70 ms (cards), 120 ms (hero lines)
Hover lift	translateY(−4 px) + shadow glow

Reduced motion: durations → 0–120 ms, no transforms/parallax, fades only.

3. Breakpoints and Grid

Name	Width	Columns	Notes
xs	< 480	4	single column cards
sm	480–767	4	
md (tablet)	768–1023	8	2-column cards
lg (laptop)	1024–1439	12	3-column cards
xl (desktop)	≥ 1440	12	wider gutters, same max width

Touch targets ≥ 44×44 px. Test also landscape phones (height < 500 px): nav compact, hero not clipped.

4. Component Specifications

- **Buttons:** Primary (accent fill, white text, 48 px height, radius pill, hover glow + arrow nudge), Secondary (transparent, 1 px border, hover surface-2), Ghost/Link (underline on hover, accent-text). States: default, hover, focus-visible, active (scale .98), disabled (50 %, no pointer), loading (spinner, width locked).
- **Cards:** surface background, 1 px border, radius lg. Variants: Project, Service, Testimonial, Achievement, Blog, Stat. Hover: lift + border accent 35 % + image zoom 1.05 (600 ms).
- **Badges/chips:** pill, 12–13 px text; category chips are toggle buttons (`aria-pressed`). Admin `SAMPLE` badge uses warning colour.
- **Inputs:** 48 px height, surface-2 background, visible label above (never placeholder-only), focus ring 2 px `--focus` + 2 px offset, error state with icon + text + red border (colour never the only signal).
- **Dialog/Lightbox/Drawer:** dimmed backdrop, focus trap, Escape, close button 44 px, return focus.
- **Toasts:** bottom-centre mobile / bottom-right desktop, `role="status"`, 4 s, pause on hover.
- **Skeletons:** same shape/size as the content; shimmer disabled under reduced motion.
- **Tooltips:** only for icon-only buttons; keyboard-focus visible.
- **Icons:** lucide, 20/24 px, stroke 1.75, always with accessible names when interactive.

5. Public Site — Section Layouts

5.1 Intro overlay (full viewport)

```
+-------------------------------------------------+
| [Name / role label  — top-left, small]  [Skip →]  |
|                                                 |
|            AI VIDEO (cover, focal point)        |
|                                                 |
|  [⏯ Play/Pause] [🔇 Unmute] [CC]   ---progress---|
+-------------------------------------------------+
```

- Video fills the viewport with `object-fit: cover`; focal point from admin keeps face inside the central safe area (middle 60 % width on desktop, upper-centre on mobile).

- Skip button top-right (always visible, 44 px, glass pill). Controls bottom bar in glass; on mobile sit above the safe-area inset. Subtitles sit above controls with a soft text shadow/background so they stay readable.
- Loading: poster + thin accent progress line; no spinner covering the face.
- Fallback: poster dimmed, big circular Play button, link “Enter site”.

5.2 Transition choreography (≈ 1.3 s)

t (ms)	Event
0	Controls fade out (150 ms); video keeps last frame
0–500	Video container scales 1 → 0.94 and gains `--r-lg` radius while backdrop glow rises
300–900	Clip-path mask expands the hero from the video’s centre; light-sweep gradient passes left → right
700	Navbar slides down + fades (350 ms)
850	H1 lines reveal (mask-up, 120 ms stagger)
1050	Intro paragraph fades up
1200	CTA buttons fade up (70 ms stagger); overlay unmounted at 1400

Hero background colour at transition start equals the video’s end colour (`--intro-end-color`) so no flash appears. Skip variant: same sequence compressed to ≈ 600 ms. Reduced motion: 200 ms cross-fade only.

5.3 Navbar

- Desktop: floating pill, 16 px from top, max-width 1100 px, glass. Left: logo/name (monogram + name). Centre: Home, About, Projects, Services, Resume, Contact. Right: theme toggle, search/command-palette icon (flag), **Let’s Work Together** primary button.
- Active link: accent-text colour + 2 px underline/dot that slides between items.
- Scrolled (> 80 px): height 64 → 56, stronger blur and border; thin scroll-progress line along bottom edge.

- Mobile: logo + hamburger; drawer slides from right (glass, 88 % width), large link list (min 56 px rows), CTA at bottom, theme toggle and socials.

5.4 Hero

- **Desktop:** 12-col grid. Left 7 cols: availability pill, eyebrow (“Hi, I’m”), H1 name, rotating role line (optional, 3–4 s per role, pause on hover/focus, static under reduced motion), value proposition (max 2 lines), two CTAs, social icons. Right 5 cols: portrait with soft mask, gradient ring and subtle floating glow (parallax ⩽ 12 px, off on touch).
- **Mobile:** portrait first (aspect 4:5, max 60 vh), then text and full-width CTAs; scroll indicator hidden.
- Hero must fit its core content (name, role, CTA) within the first viewport on a 360 × 640 phone.
- Background: dark base, two blurred accent orbs, fine noise texture (2 % opacity), optional particles (disabled on low-power/mobile).

5.5 About + Skills

- Two-column: portrait with reveal mask + bio (short paragraph, “Read more” expands the long bio), values as 3 icon cards, CTA row (Download CV if exists, Contact).
- Skills: tabbed category control (`role="tablist"`) with skill chips and “used in” project links; Tools wall as a grid of logo tiles (grayscale → colour on hover/focus) with visible names. **No percentage bars.**

5.6 Featured projects / gallery

- Home: one **large featured card** (16:9, text overlay panel) + 2×2/1×N grid of cards.
- Card anatomy: 16:10 cover (lazy), category badge, title (H3), 2-line description, tech chips (max 3 + “+2”), footer actions (View Case Study; Live Demo / Source only when URL exists).
- `/projects`: sticky filter bar (chips left, search right, sort dropdown), results count, grid, Load more, empty state illustration (simple SVG) with “Clear filters”.
- Whole-card link uses the stretched-link pattern so inner buttons stay separately focusable.

5.7 Case study page

- Header: breadcrumb, title, one-line summary, meta row (role, date, tools, category), share button.
- Cover media full container width. Then 2-column layout on desktop: sticky side panel (Overview: role, tools, date, links) + main prose column (720 px) with sections Problem, Approach, Process, Gallery (masonry/2-col with lightbox), Challenges & Solutions, Results.
- End: Previous/Next cards, Related projects (3), CTA band “Have a similar project?”.

5.8 Services, pricing, FAQ

- Service cards 3-up with icon, title, one-line problem, deliverable bullets, “Starting at … / Request a quote”, CTA. Process strip (4 steps with numbered connector line). Pricing packages as 3 columns with the middle highlighted only if the owner marks it “recommended”. FAQ accordion (`<details>` -style with ARIA), single column 720 px.

5.9 Experience / Resume

- Vertical timeline with accent line and dot markers; entries stagger in; each shows role, org, dates, 2–3 bullet outcomes. Education & certifications as compact cards. Download CV button top-right of the section.

5.10 Testimonials

- Card slider (1 per view mobile, 2–3 desktop), manual arrows + dots, optional autoplay with visible Pause button. Quote text 18 px, name, role/company, optional photo. Hidden entirely when no approved entries.

5.11 Contact

- Two columns on desktop: left = heading, short text, email (copy button), WhatsApp, socials, availability; right = form card. Mobile: stacked, form first after heading.
- Form: labels above fields, 2-col grid for service/budget on desktop, textarea with live character counter, consent checkbox, Turnstile widget, primary submit button full-width on mobile. Success state replaces the form with checkmark animation (static under reduced motion).

5.12 Footer

- Logo, short line, nav links, socials, Replay Intro, theme toggle, Privacy link, © year. Back-to-top button appears after one viewport of scroll.

5.13 404 and error pages

- Large “404” with accent gradient, short message, buttons Home and Projects, optional search. Error boundary page: message + Reload button.

6. Imagery and Content Guidelines

- Sample data uses locally generated gradient/abstract SVG covers and a neutral silhouette portrait — no stock faces, logos or brand marks.
- Real images: WebP/AVIF, consistent aspect ratios (cover 16:10, portrait 4:5, OG 1200×630), alt text describes content/purpose.
- Tone of voice: confident, friendly, plain language, short sentences; CTA verbs (Explore, Discuss, Download, Say hello). Avoid superlatives that cannot be proven.
- Microcopy examples: empty search — “Nothing matches ‘{query}’. Try another keyword or clear filters.”; form error — “Please enter a valid email, e.g. name@example.com”.

7. Admin Panel Design

7.1 Shell

- **Left sidebar** (260 px desktop, collapsible to icons; drawer on mobile): Dashboard, Content (Projects, Categories, Skills, Experience, Services, Testimonials, Blog), Site (Intro, Media, Settings, Navigation, SEO), Inbox (with unread count badge), Analytics, Sample Data, System (Users, Audit log, Backup).
- **Top bar:** page title + breadcrumb, global search (Ctrl/Cmd+K), “View site”, theme toggle, user menu (profile, sign out). Environment badge: DEMO / STAGING / LIVE.
- Same design tokens as public site, but denser: 14 px body, 40 px inputs, neutral surfaces, accent used only for primary actions and selection.

7.2 Key screens

- **Dashboard:** row of 4 KPI cards, line chart (views), Launch Readiness checklist with progress ring, recent inquiries, quick actions, sample-content counter card (warning colour).
- **Lists (projects, inquiries, media):** data table with search, filters, column sort, bulk-select bar, row actions menu, pagination, drag handle for orderable lists, status pills (Draft grey, Scheduled blue, Published green, Archived muted, Sample amber).
- **Editors:** two-column on desktop — main form/tabs left, sticky side panel right (Status & Publish, Featured, Schedule, Preview, Revisions, SEO snapshot). Sticky bottom save bar on mobile with unsaved-changes indicator.
- **Rich text editor:** toolbar (headings, bold/italic, lists, quote, code, link, image from Media Library, callout); outputs sanitized content; word count.
- **Media picker:** modal with upload zone, grid, search, selected preview, alt-text field.
- **Intro manager:** left = upload cards (desktop video, mobile video, poster with focal-point picker, captions), right = live preview frame with device switcher (desktop/mobile) and test buttons.
- **Inbox:** master-detail (list left, message right on desktop; separate screens on mobile).
- **Analytics:** date-range selector, chart cards with accessible data tables toggle.
- **Confirm dialogs** for destructive actions: red primary button, explicit item names; type-to-confirm for bulk/danger actions.
- **Empty states:** illustration + one primary action (“Add your first project”).

8. Accessibility Design Checklist

- Focus ring visible on every interactive element, never removed.
- Skip-to-content link is the first focusable element.
- Heading order logical; one H1 per page.
- Colour is never the only indicator (icons/text with status).
- Interactive target size ≥ 44 px (24 px minimum inside dense admin tables, with spacing).
- Video: captions, transcript, no flashing > 3 times/second, sound only on user request.
- Carousels and rotating text provide pause controls.
- Test with keyboard only, screen reader (NVDA/VoiceOver), 200 % zoom and 320 px width.

9. Responsive Rules Summary

Element	Mobile	Tablet	Desktop
Navbar	Logo + hamburger drawer	Pill with condensed links	Full pill with CTA
Hero	Portrait on top, stacked text	2-col, smaller portrait	7/5 split with parallax
Project grid	1 col	2 cols	3 cols (featured spans 2)
Case study	Single column, overview collapsible	Single column	Sticky side panel
Contact	Stacked	Stacked	2 columns
Effects	Particles/parallax/custom cursor off	Reduced	Full (if not low-power)

10. Design Deliverables for the Builder

The builder must produce: tokens in `globals.css` and `tailwind.config`, a `/styleguide` dev-only route showing all components and states (excluded from production), and then screens in this order: tokens → components → navbar/footer → hero → sections → project pages → intro overlay → admin shell → admin screens. No section may introduce colours, fonts, radii or motion values outside these tokens.